PART IV · HARMONY · TIPS

# When a chord sounds wrong

A chord that sounds wrong usually has one small slip. Name the slip, fix that one note, and the chord comes right.

TIP

### What you notice, what to check

| WHAT YOU NOTICE | CHECK | TURN TO |
|---|---|---|
| A chord sounds sour | **the kind**: keys between, 3 + 2 or 2 + 3 | p. 70 |
| Your hand jumps all over | **an inversion**: keep the shared note still | p. 74 |
| A big chord sounds muddy | **leave notes out**: drop the 5th first | p. 80 |
| A sharp or flat surprises you | **a guest**: sharps go up, flats go down | p. 84 |
| The end does not feel finished | **the cadence**: end with V → I | p. 87 |
| The left hand fights the tune | **the main notes**: pick the snowman holding them | p. 89 |

## Four ways to learn chords fast

**1 Build, then play**
Say the snowman (C E G) before your fingers go down.

**2 Hands alone first**
Left hand chords alone, then the tune alone, then together.

**3 One trip a week**
Learn one progression, then play it in three keys.

**4 Listen for the kind**
Play major and minor side by side: bright, then dark.

EXAMPLE

### Fix a sour chord




1 **It sounds dark**, but the music wants a bright C chord.

2 **Count the keys between:** 2, then 3. That is minor.

3 **Move one note:** E♭ up to E makes 3 + 2. Bright again.

One note was off: **fix the middle of the snowman**.

THINK OF IT Like a mechanic: one odd sound points to one part. Fix that part and the engine runs smoothly.